AA-B-606C
February 15, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. AA-B-00606B(GSA-FSS)
April 4, 1968 and
Fed. Spec. AA-B-606A
June 10, 1953

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BOXES, FILING, WOOD

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers portable wood filing boxes with, and without compressors (see figure 1).

1.2 Classification. The filing boxes shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - With compressor.

Size 1 - For 3 x 5 inch cards.
Size 2 - For 4 x 6 inch cards.
Size 3 - For 5 x 8 inch cards.

Type II - Without compressor.

Size 1 - For 3 x 5 inch cards.
Size 2 - For 4 x 6 inch cards.
Size 3 - For 5 x 8 inch cards.

1.2.1 Sizes. Unless otherwise specified, the boxes shall be of the sizes shown in table III.

1.2.2 Colors of finish. The boxes shall be of the following colors of finish, as specified (see 3.1.4 and 6.2).

Light Oak
Walnut

(Sample panels of this color are available from the Business Service Center, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, DC 20405, or from the Business Service Center of the nearest GSA Regional Office.)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

MMM-A-100 - Adhesive, Animal Glue.
MMM-A-125 - Adhesive, Casein-Type, Water and Mold Resistant.
MMM-A-188 - Adhesive, Urea-Resin Type (Liquid and Powder).
MMM-A-193 - Adhesive Vinyl Acetate Resin Emulsion.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes: Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

FSC 7520

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Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141 - Paint, Varnish, Lacquer, and Related Materials; Methods of Inspection, Sampling and Testing.
Int. Fed. Test Method Std. No. 00304 - Metal, Chemical Test Methods (For Identification).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-1363 - Measurement of Wood Content.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Commercial Standards:

Commercial Standard CS-236 - Mat-Formed Particleboard.
Product Standard PS-51-71 - Hardwood and Decorative Plywood.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material shall conform to the applicable requirements specified herein. Where the material is not definitely defined, it shall be of the quality and composition best suited for the intended purpose.

3.1.1 Solid wood (for exterior parts). The solid wood shall be free from brashness, discoloration, worm holes, honey combs, checks or splits, knots over 1/2 inch diameter, cluster of knots, or other defects which will affect appearance or serviceability of the boxes. (See 3.1.4).

3.1.2 Plywood. The plywood shall be at least equal to the requirements of Product Standard PS-51-71. The plywood shall be not less than type II, water-resistant bond, and face veneers and cross banding shall be not less than Sound Grade 2. (See 3.1.4.)

3.1.3 Particleboard. The particleboard shall conform to the requirements of Commercial Standard CS-236, Type I, Density (Grade) B, Class 1.

3.1.4 Wood and varieties. The exposed solid wood and plywood veneer parts of the boxes shall be of the species of wood listed in table I. The solid wood and plywood veneers to be used in a single box for the finish specified shall be of one of the species shown in table I, opposite the color of finish (see 6.2).

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TABLE I. Varieties of wood

Color of finish	Species of wood
Light Oak	Ash Hickory Oak
Walnut	Ash Hackberry Beech Maple Birch Oak Cherry Pecan Walnut Sweetgum

3.1.5 Seasoning. All wood shall be uniformly kiln-dried and cured in controlled warm storage for a sufficient period of time to insure a uniform distribution of moisture among the individual pieces. Moisture content shall be 5 to 8 percent as determined by MIL-STD-1363 at the time of box assembly. After gluing, built-up solid parts shall be permitted to cure or condition to insure uniform distribution of glue joint moisture and eliminate sunken joints, spring-back, and built-up stresses that may impair serviceability or appearance.

3.1.6 Adhesive. The adhesive used in the construction of the boxes shall conform to, or exceed the performance of the specified adhesives stated in table II.

TABLE II. Adhesive and application

Adhesive	Applications
Animal glue, grade J-2 of MMM-A-100, or vinyl acetate adhesive MMM-A-193	Assembly joints and edge joining of built-up solid panels, and gluing of felt bottom.
Casein-type MMM-A-125, or Urea-Resin type MMM-A-188	All assembly joints, built-up panels, or plywood lamination.

3.1.7 Felt. The felt shall contain not less than 25 percent new, reused, or reprocessed wool, or a combination thereof, and the balance shall be any fiber except bast fibers. The weight of the felt shall be not less than 4 ounces per square yard.

3.2 Hardware components. The gage number shown in subsequent paragraphs shall conform the manufacturer's Standard Gage for Steel Sheet, or United States Steel Wire Gage, as applicable.

3.2.1 Compressor (for type I boxes). The compressor shall consist of a plate, rod, and finger release spring torsion lever stop. The compressor components shall be made of cold-rolled steel, or corrosion resistant steel. The plate shall be approximately the size of the card for which the box is designed, and shall be not less than 18 gage thick. The rod shall be not less than 7 gage in diameter. Components made of cold-rolled steel shall be plated with nickel, cadmium or zink, or the plate or finger release shall be coated with an appropriate pigmented baked enamel, not less than 1.0 Mil thick, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.4. The compressor shall operate smoothly and easily, and shall lock automatically at any point.

3.2.2 Butt hinges. The hinges shall be made of cold-rolled steel, and shall be brass plated.

3.2.2.1 Type I. The hinge shall be not less than 0.042 inch thick. The length of the hinge at the joint shall be not less than 1-1/2 inches, and the open hinge width shall be not less than 1-1/4 inches. Each wing shall have not less than two screw holes.

3.2.2.2 Type II (stop hinge). The hinge shall be not less than 0.040 inch thick. The length of the hinge at the joint shall be not less than 1 inch, and the open hinge width shall be not less than 1-3/6 inches. Each wing shall have not less than two screw holes. The stop hinge shall open a minimum of 90°, and not more than 110°.

3.2.3 Quadrant. The quadrant shall be similar to the one shown in figure 1. The quadrant shall be made of cold-rolled steel, not less than 0.030 inch thick, and shall be brass plated.

3.3 Design. The design of the boxes shall be as shown in figures 1 and 2. Minor deviations from the illustration are permitted provided the boxes are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of the specification. The dimensions given in figures 1 and 2 are minimum inside dimensions.

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3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 Type I. The boxes shall conform to the applicable material and hardware components requirements specified in 3.1 and 3.2, respectively. The sides and ends shall be made of solid wood, not less than 5/16 inch thick. The top shall be made of solid wood, or plywood (not less than three plies), and shall be not less than 3/16 inch thick. The top shall be tongued into the sides and ends of the box and secured by adhesive, or securely glued flush to the sides and ends. The bottom shall be made of solid wood, plywood, or particleboard not less than 1/4 inch thick, and shall be tongued into the sides and ends and secured by adhesive, or solid wood and plywood bottoms shall be glued and nailed flush to the sides and ends. All edges and corners shall be rounded, with the exception of the contact edges of the lid and base section. The filler strip forming the compressor channel, shall be not less than 5/16 inch thick, and not less than 1-1/2 inches wide, and shall be securely glued to the inside bottom of the box. The compressor rod shall be centered in the channel and secured to the ends of the box. Each box shall have two quadrants. The quadrants shall be so installed to assure equal support to both ends of the lid and permit the lid to open not less than 90° and not more than 110°.

3.4.1.1 Alternate bottom. The type I boxes may have a steel bottom. The steel shall be not less than 24 gage (0.0239 inch). The center of the bottom shall be channel-formed to accomodate the compressor unit. The bottom shall be let into the sides and ends not less than 1/8 inch. The bottom shall be finished the same as the compressor unit. In lieu of felt, the metal bottom may have not less than four suitable non-marking rubber feet.

3.4.2 Type II. The boxes shall conform to the applicable material and hardware components requirements specified in 3.1 and 3.2 respectively. The sides and ends shall be made of solid wood, not less than 5/16 inch thick. The top and bottom shall be made of solid wood or plywood (not less than three plies), not less than 1/8 inch thick, and shall be securely glued flush to the sides and ends. All edges and corners shall be rounded with the exception of the contact edges of the lid and base section.

3.4.3 Framing. The framing of all vertical joints shall be continuous, either dovetail or lock corner. All joints shall be tight and finished flush without openings or cracks.

3.4.4 Gluing. The adhesive shall conform to the requirements specified in 3.1.6 and table II. The adhesive shall be applied to joint surfaces in an adequate and uniform manner as recommended by the adhesive manufacturer. Assembly periods, clamping, or pressing time shall be in accordance with the adhesive manufacturer's instructions.

3.4.5 Lid. The lid shall be formed by cutting the ends and sides on an ogee curve, and the cut shall start 1 inch below the top edge at the back of the box (see figures 1 and 2). The lid shall land evenly and squarely on the contact edges of the base.

3.4.6 Hinges. Type I boxes shall have two hinges conforming to 3.2.2.1, and type II boxes shall have two hinges conforming to 3.2.2.2. Each hinge shall be secured to the base and lid by not less than four screws. The screws shall be not more than 1/16 inch shorter than the thickness of the hinge and the box end to which the hinge is attached, and shall be not less than 1/4 inch away from the edges of the lid and the base.

3.4.7 Front filler. A filler piece shall be securely glued inside the front of each box. The filler shall be the full height of the card for which the box is designed, and shall not be less than 3/16 inch thick.

3.4.8 Felt. The felt shall conform to the requirements stated in 3.1.7. The felt shall be neatly and securely glued to the underside of the boxes. (See 3.4.1.1.)

3.4.9 Finish of wood parts. Wood parts normally exposed to view, shall be thoroughly cleaned and sanded smooth. Finish shall consist of the following:

(a) Application of stain and lacquer toner.
(b) 1 coat of clear stain, if required.
(c) 1 coat lacquer sealer.
(d) 1 filler coat.
(e) 2 coats clear lacquer.
(f) Rubbing.

The application of finishing materials, drying time, cleaning, and rubbing shall be controlled to produce items with a smooth, uniform surface, without blisters, runs, wrinkles and other defects. All unexposed parts shall have at least one coat of high solids lacquer sealer.

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3.4.10 Dimensions. The inside dimensions of the boxes shall be as specified in table III. The inside height dimensions for type I boxes shall be measured from the top of the filler strip to the underside of the top of the box. (See figure 1.)

TABLE III. Minimum inside dimensions

Type	Size	Width	Height	Depth
I	1	5-1/8	3-1/2	9*
I	2	6-1/8	4-1/2	9*
I	3	8-1/8	5-1/2	9*
II	1	5-1/8	3-1/2	3-1/8
II	2	6-1/8	4-1/2	3-1/8
II	3	8-1/8	5-1/2	3-1/8

* Minimum usable space 7-1/2 inches.

3.4.11 Identification marking. Each box shall be legibly and permanently marked on the underside of the lid with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

3.4.12 Workmanship. The boxes shall be free from defects which may impair serviceability or appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection and testing of base material. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that base material is manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications, standards and other documents.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All filing boxes of the same type and size presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for purpose of examination and tests.

4.2.2 Sampling for examination and tests. Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Sampling for visual and dimensional examinations. A random sample of filing boxes shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit shall be one box. The box shall be examined for defects listed in table IV. The Inspection Level shall be S-3, and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery examination. Sampling shipping containers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot fully prepared for delivery. Defects of closure listed in table V shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 Sampling for tests. A random sample of filing boxes shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one filing box. The boxes shall be subjected to the applicable test(s) specified in 4.4. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, and the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table IV. Any box having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Type and size	Type and size not as specified (see 1.2).
Color	Color not as specified (see 1.2.2).
Material and components	Material and components not as specified (see 3.1 thru 3.2.2.3, as applicable).
Design	Design not as specified (see 3.3 and figures 1 and 2).
Construction: Type I	Construction of type I boxes not as specified (see 3.4.1, 3.4.1.1 and 3.4.3 thru 3.4.9).
Type II	Construction of type II boxes not as specified (see 3.4.2, and 3.4.3 thru 3.4.9).
Dimensions	Dimension not as specified (see 3.4.10 and table III).
Identification marking	Identification marking not as specified (see 3.4.11).
Workmanship	Workmanship not in accordance with 3.4.12.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be examined for defects listed in table V, to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 are complied with. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery.

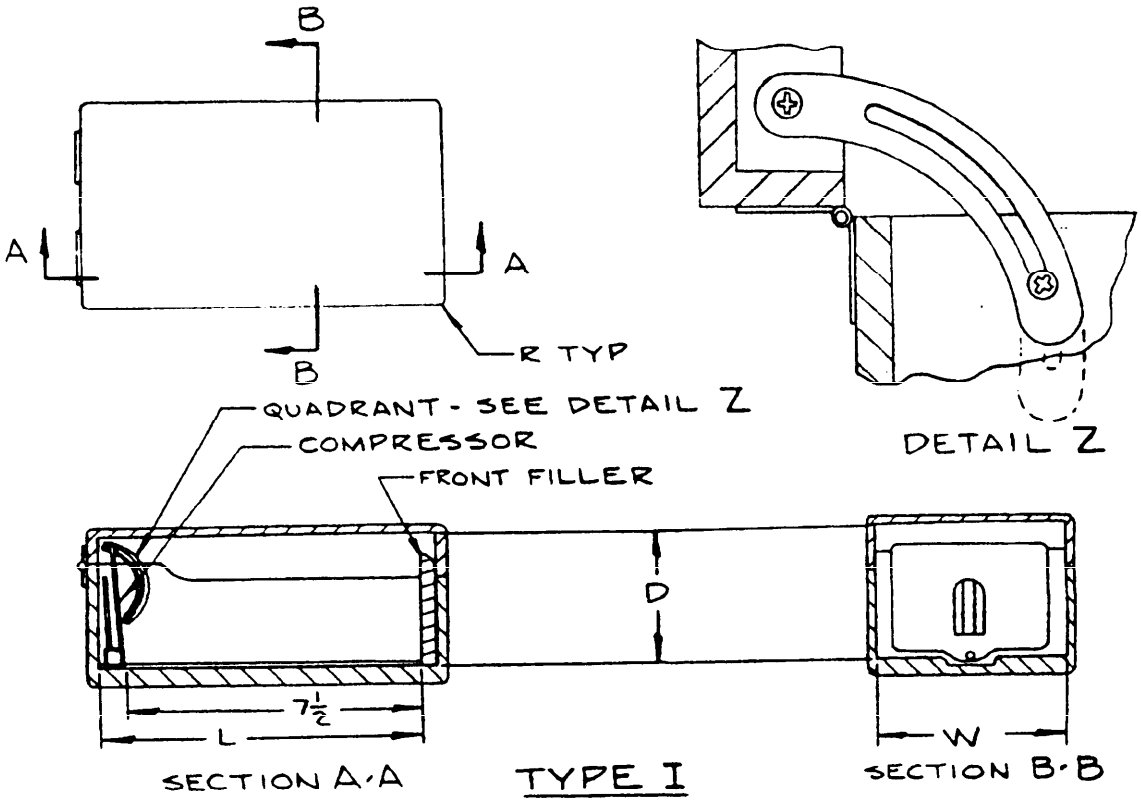
TABLE V. Classification of preparation of delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect, illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or not as specified. Any component damaged affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, and inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.
Contents	Number per bundle and container is more or less than required.
Weight	Weight exceeds requirements.

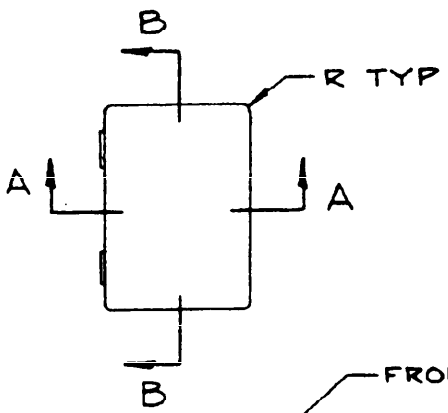
4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Compressor tests. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to the following application test(s). Any sample failing the test(s) shall be considered defective. If the number of defective boxes exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

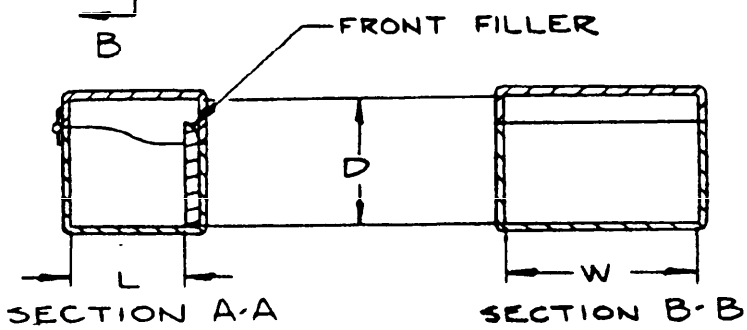
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TYPE I



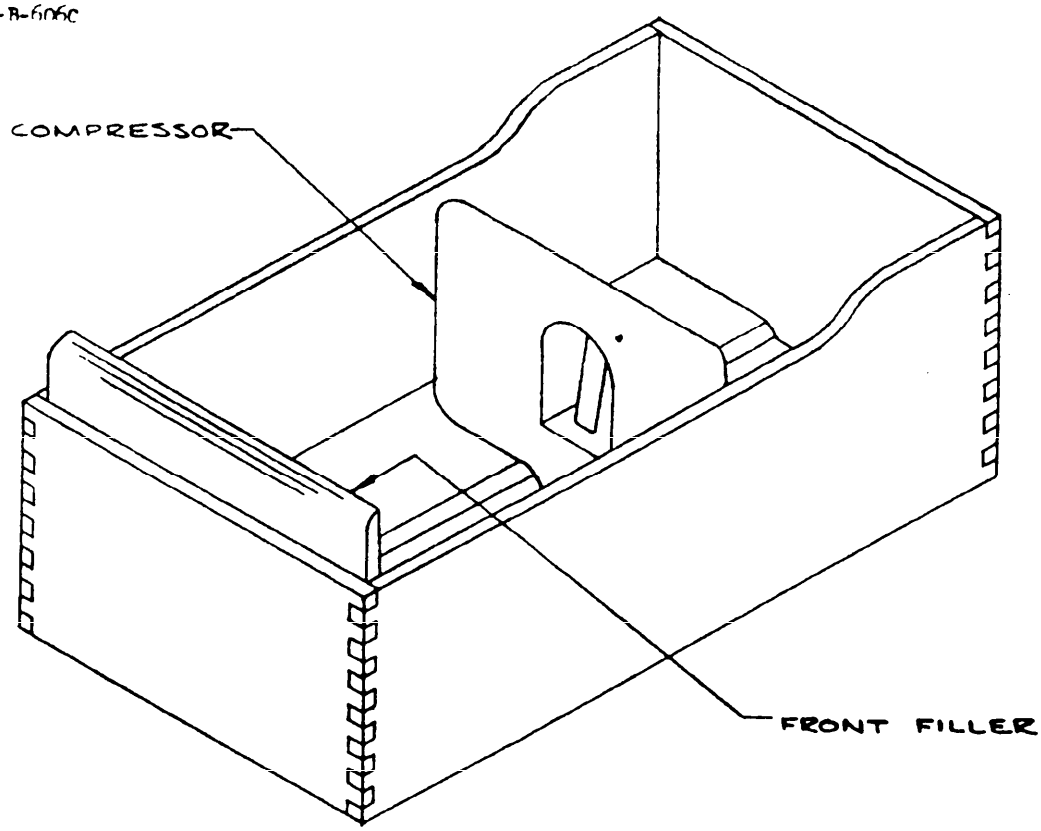
TYPE & SIZE	L	W	D
TYPE I			
SIZE 1	9"	5⅛"	3½"
SIZE 2	9"	6⅛"	4½"
SIZE 3	9"	8⅛"	5½"
TYPE II			
SIZE 1	3⅛"	5⅛"	3½"
SIZE 2	3⅛"	6⅛"	4½"
SIZE 3	3⅛"	8⅛"	5½"



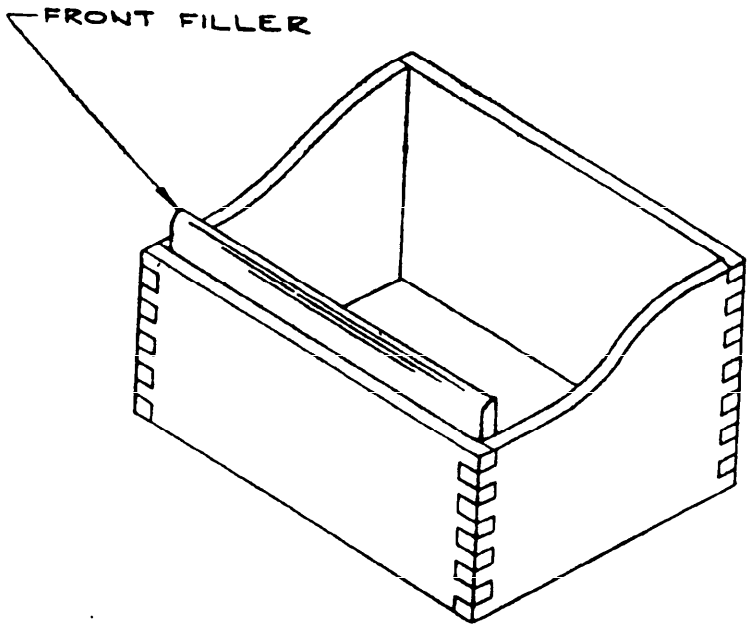
TYPE II

FIGURE 1

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TYPE I, WITH
COVER REMOVED



TYPE II, WITH
COVER REMOVED

FIGURE 2

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4.4.1.1 Identification of corrosion resisting steel. The compressor unit shall be tested in accordance with Test Method 107 of Int. Fed. Test Method Standard No. 00304, for compliance with 3.2.1.

4.4.1.2 Identification for presence of cadmium and zink plating. The compressor unit shall be tested in accordance with Test Method 103 of Int. Fed. Test Method Standard No. 00304, for compliance with 3.2.1.

4.4.1.3 Identification for presence of nickel plating. The compressor unit shall be tested in accordance with Test Method 108 of Int. Fed. Test Method Standard No. 00304, for compliance with 3.2.1.

4.4.1.4 Thickness of enamel coating test. The thickness of the coating of enamel shall be determined to the nearest 0.0001 inch by Test Method 6183, of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141, for compliance with 3.2.1.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A and B. Each box shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. Each box shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Level C. Boxes shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Unit packages of one style, size, and material shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Thirty-six boxes without compressors, twelve boxes for 3 by 5 inch cards with compressors, or eight boxes for 5 by 8 inch cards with compressors, of one stock number, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be not less than 275 p.s.i. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Boxes of one stock number shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The filing boxes are intended to be used as a file box for the maintenance of index cards or forms printed on card stock.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, and size (see 1.2, 1.2.1, 3.4.10 and table III).
(c) Color (see 1.2.2, 3.1.4, and table I).
(d) Inspection responsibility, if other than as specified herein (see 4.1).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Quantities of unit packages in shipping container (see 5.2.1).

NO OFFICIAL DOD INTEREST HAS BEEN REGISTERED

Preparing activity:
GSA-FSS -

User activity:
Army - GL

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